Qiang (Steven) Wu

Department of Political Science
University at Albany, SUNY
Email: swu26@albany.edu
Personal Website LinkedIn
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Education

Texas A&M University – Bush School of Government & Public Service
Ph.D. in Political Science, August 2026, College Station, TX

- Major: **International Relations**
- Minor: **Comparative Politics & Political Methodology**
- **Dissertation:** *Contesting the Liberal Order? Chinese Economic Statecraft, Alternative Institutions, and the Diffusion of Governance Norms*
- **Committee:** Matthew Fuhrmann (Chair), Hyeran Jo (Co-Chair), Matt Malis, David Bearce.

Johns Hopkins University – School of Advanced International Studies (SAIS)
M.A. in International Economics & China Studies, Specialization in Economic Policy, Dean's Scholarship, 2020, Washington, DC

Kyoto University – Graduate School of Economics
M.A. in Economics, Japan Development Scholarship (JDS Scholar), Fully Funded by JICA, 2014, Kyoto, Japan

Peking University – School of International Studies
M.A. in International Relations (Great Power Politics and Diplomacy), 2012, Beijing, China

Peking University – School of Government
B.A. in Political Science & Public Administration, 2004, Beijing, China

Academic Appointments

University at Albany, SUNY, Adjunct Lecturer in Political Science, August 2026–Present

Publications and Research in Progress

Published Working Paper

- **Wu, Qiang.** *"Foreign Aid and Leadership Support in Informal International Institutions: Evidence from China–Africa Cooperation, 2000–2024."* *AidData Working Paper* No. 145. Williamsburg, VA: AidData at William & Mary.

Editor-Reviewed Paper

- **Wu, Qiang.** 2020. "*China's Use of Trade Retaliation in Territorial Disputes: Interdependence with a Difficult but Rational Power.*" *SAIS China Studies Review*, Volume 6

Working Papers

- **Wu, Qiang.** *"Asymmetric Interdependence and Security Reassurance under Great Power Rivalry: China Dependence and U.S.-Involved Joint Military Exercises in the Indo-Pacific, 1992–2016"*
- **Wu, Qiang.** *"Output Legitimacy Beyond Borders: Does Chinese Development Finance Diffuse Its Model in Africa?"*
- **Wu, Qiang**, Kyung Suk Lee, Kirby Goidel, and Clifford Young. "*Income, Populism, Nativism, and Partisanship: How Interests and Ideologies Shape Attitudes Toward Trade and Globalization."*
- **Wu, Qiang** and Quan Li. *"Cold War, Democratization and the Move to Free Trade in the Developing Countries"*

Policy Essay

- **Wu, Qiang.** 2020. "Time to Retrieve the First Heart of Multilateralism." *The Bretton Woods Committee*.

Book Project

- Invited book project on U.S.–China relations and Indo-Pacific dynamics, Palgrave Macmillan (invitation following an APSA 2024 presentation).

Policy Experience

- **Policy Aide to Committee Chair Li Zhaoxing (former Foreign Minister) and Vice Chair Ma Wenpu, Foreign Affairs Committee, National People's Congress, China (2014–2017; 2007–2012)**
  – Legislation and Policy. Drafted foreign policy–related legislation and reports, including analysis of how China's international treaty obligations apply to Hong Kong and Macau; drafted a border-infrastructure proposal for the Belt and Road Initiative that was incorporated into **China's 13th Five-Year Plan** (2016–2020).
- **Policy Communication Strategist, Annual Plenary Sessions of the National People's Congress, China (2014–2017)**
  – Produced public communication materials on economy, Taiwan/Hong Kong/Macau issues, and foreign policy.

- **Parliamentary Diplomacy Consultant, National People's Congress, China (2007-2012)**
  – Advised Chinese Congress delegations to the Chamber of Deputies (Rome, 2011) and State Duma (Moscow, 2010); supported hosting parliamentary delegations from the European Parliament, Australia, Russia, Iran, and Cambodia.
- **Selected Policy Writing in Chinese**
  – **Wu, Qiang.** 2011. "Wei renmin fuwu zai renshi" [Reconsidering the Relationship between Government and People]. *Ziguang Ge (Policy Journal of the Central Government):* 90–91.
  – **Wu, Qiang.** 2010. "Zhonghua wenming youshi wuzhong" [The History and Future of Chinese Civilization]. *Outstanding Articles in the Congress Staff Essay Contest.* Beijing: National People's Congress.
  – **Wu, Qiang.** 2009. "Dui minzhu de sikao" [Thoughts on Democracy]. *Outstanding Articles in the Congress Staff Essay Contest.* Beijing: China Democracy and Law Press.

Conferences & Workshops

Conferences

- **Wu, Qiang**, "*Foreign Aid and Leadership Support in Informal International Institutions: Evidence from China–Africa Cooperation."*
  – **APSA** Annual Meeting, 2026 (Panel organizer)
- **Wu, Qiang.** "*Money Yes, Friend No: How U.S. Allies and Partners Balance Economic Dependence on China and Security Cooperation with the United States."*
  – **APSA** Annual Meeting, 2025 (Invited panelist)
- **Wu, Qiang.** "*Economic Dependence and Security Cooperation with a Third-Party Great Power: The Case of the Indo-Pacific."*
  – **APSA** Annual Meeting, 2024; **MPSA** Annual Conference, 2023
- **Wu, Qiang** and Quan Li. "*Cold War, Democratization, and the Move to Free Trade in Developing Countries."*
  – **APSA** Annual Meeting, 2023; **ISA** Annual Convention, 2023
- **Wu, Qiang**, Kyung Suk Lee, Kirby Goidel, and Clifford Young. "*Globalization, International Trade, and Immigration: Perceptions and Realities."*
  – **SPSA** Annual Meeting, 2023
- **Wu, Qiang**, Quan Li, and Nehemia Geva. "*Do Trade Partners' Trade Practices Affect American Public Preferences on Trade Policy? When and How?"*
  – **ISA** Annual Convention, 2024; **MPSA** Annual Conference, 2022; **ISPP** Annual Meeting, 2022

Workshops & Symposia

- **Wu, Qiang**, "*Output Legitimacy Beyond Borders: Does Chinese Development Finance Diffuse Its Model in Africa?"*
  – Junior Fellows Convening, Institute for Humane Studies, 2026
- **Wu, Qiang**, "*Foreign Aid and Leadership Support in Informal International Institutions: Evidence from China–Africa Cooperation."*
  – Job Market Papers Workshop, Institute for Humane Studies, 2026

- **Wu, Qiang**, Kyung Suk Lee, Kirby Goidel, and Clifford Young. "*Income, Populism, Nativism, and Partisanship: How Interests and Ideologies Shape Attitudes Toward Trade and Globalization."*
  – Graduate Conference for the Social Sciences (2026), Contemporary Challenges in Trade Workshop I & II (2025), Institute for Humane Studies
- **Wu, Qiang.** "*How Economic Dependence on China Shapes U.S. Allies and Partners' Security Relations with the United States: The Case of the Indo-Pacific."*
  – Trade Papers Workshop, Institute for Humane Studies (hosted at Harvard University), 2024; Junior Scholars Symposium, Cato Institute, 2023
- **Wu, Qiang.** "*Economy and Security in International Relations."*
  – Academy for Future Faculty, Texas A&M University, 2024
- **Wu, Qiang** and Quan Li. "*Does Sino-U.S. Strategic Rivalry Lead to Economic Rivalry in the Indo-Pacific Region?"*
  – Taiwan-America Conference on Contemporary China, National Chengchi University, Taiwan, 2021

Fellowships, Honors, and Awards

Fellowships

- **Junior Fellows Program,** Institute for Humane Studies (IHS), Summer 2026 ($7,000)
- **Graduate Fellowship**, Institute for Humane Studies (IHS), 2025–2026 ($8,000)
- **Junior Scholar**, Carnegie International Policy Scholars Consortium and Network (IPSCON), Kissinger Center, Johns Hopkins SAIS, 2024–2025 (about 20 scholars selected annually)
  – Selected as one of approximately 20 junior scholars annually; Includes Foreign Policy Retreat, Minnowbrook, NY; Foreign Policy Workshop, Washington, DC; Carnegie Square Lectures, on-line
- **Humane Studies Fellowship**, Institute for Humane Studies (IHS), 2024–2025 ($5,000)
- **Program Fellow**, Foreign Policy Impact Summer Institute (First Cohort of 10 Fellows), Colorado State University, 2025 ($3,000)

Honors

- **First Place**, Business and Political Science Section (Graduate), Student Research Week, Texas A&M University, 2023
- **Second Place**, Henry Owen Memorial Award, Bretton Woods Committee, 2020
- **First Prize** (2010) and **Second Prize** (2011), National People's Congress Staff Essay Contest.

Grants

- Research Grant, Department of Political Science, Texas A&M University, 2024 ($1,500), 2023 ($1,500), 2022 ($1,500), 2021 ($1,000)
- Methods Training Grant, Department of Political Science, Texas A&M University, 2025. ($1,500).

- Travel Grant, Department of Political Science, Texas A&M University, 2022–2024; Institute for Humane Studies, 2023–2026; ISA, 2024; Cato Institute, 2023; National Chengchi University, 2021

Scholarships

– Dean's Scholarship, Johns Hopkins SAIS, 2019–2020 ($12,500)
– JDS Scholarship, Japan International Cooperation Agency, 2012–2014 (~$50,000)

Teaching Experience

Instructor of Record:

University at Albany, SUNY

- RPOS 102: ***Comparative and International Politic*s**, Fall 2026
  – Incorporated group simulations to encourage teamwork, reduce reliance on AI-generated papers, and critical thinking.
- RINT 507: ***Statistics for International Affairs Managers and Policy Analysts***, Spring 2027

Texas A&M University

- *POLS 429**: Issues in World Politics** (Undergraduate, 35 students), Spring 2025 & Fall* 2024
  – Designed and taught full course on U.S.–China relations. Incorporated group essays to encourage collaboration.

Education University of Hong Kong

- ***Introduction to Stata (Online),** Spring 2022*
  – Designed and delivered an online training bootcamp course for graduate students.

Teaching Assistant:

Johns Hopkins University, SAIS

- SA.553.106: ***Leadership in China*** (Graduate, 45 students, Online), Fall 2026. Prof. Andrew Mertha.
- SA.553.105: ***Contemporary Chinese Politics*** (Graduate, 36 students, Online), Fall 2025. Prof. Andrew Mertha.

Texas A&M University

- *POLS 209: **Political Science Research Methods*** (Undergraduate, 200 students)
  – Designed and led R programming and statistics labs for two sections (25 students each).
  – Assisted with grading homework and writing assignments.
  – Worked under Profs. Ali Kagalwala (Spring 2024), Paul Kellstedt (Fall 2023), and Hyeran Jo (Fall 2021).
- *POLS 429: **Issues in World Politics*** (Undergraduate, 35 students), Spring 2023
  – Graded assignments and occasionally substituted for Prof. Quan Li.

- *POLS 200:* ***Foundations of Political Science*** (Undergraduate, 200 students)
  – Led discussion for two sections (25 students each).
  – Assisted with grading homework and writing assignments.
  – Worked under Profs. José Antonio Cheibub (Spring 2021) and Michelle Taylor-Robinson (Fall 2020).

Teaching Fields

- International Political Economy
- International Development
- International Institutions
- International Security
- International Relations Theory
- Comparative Political Economy
- Chinese Politics and Foreign Policy
- East Asian and Indo-Pacific Politics
- U.S.-China Relations
- Quantitative Methods

Research Assistantships

Texas A&M University – Department of Political Science

- Graduate Research Assistant for Prof. Quan Li (Spring 2023, Spring 2022)
  – Supported research on international political economy and education.
- Graduate Research Assistant for Prof. Kirby Goidel (Spring & Fall 2022)
  – Contributed to survey design and analysis on public opinion and trade.

Johns Hopkins University – SAIS, International Political Economy Program

- Graduate Research Assistant for Prof. David Steinberg (Fall 2019)
  – Assisted on project "*Public Responses to Foreign Protectionism: Evidence from the U.S.–China Trade War*."

The U.S.–China Business Council

- Graduate Research Assistant for President Craig Allen (Spring 2019)
  – Researched and drafted materials for book chapter *"U.S.-China Retrospective: Forty Years of Commercial Relations."*

Unirule Institute of Economics

- Research Assistant for Prof. Hao Jiang (Spring 2018)
  – Contributed to project *"The Dynamics of Corruption and State–Business Interactions in Chinese Local Governments."*

Research Interests

- Economic Statecraft and Great Power Rivalry
- Development Finance, International Institutions, and Global Order
- The Political Economy of U.S.-China Relations

Additional Professional Experience

Peking University, Academy of e-Government

Project Manager | Beijing, China | 2006–2007

- Led negotiations and institutional coordination with EPFL to establish a collaborative master's program in e-government.
- Edited e-government training materials and organized and facilitated the Municipal E-Government Lecture Series for government officials and public-sector professionals.

LG Electronics, China Headquarters

Sales & Marketing Executive | Beijing, China | 2004–2006

- Conducted market research and competitor analysis and managed public relations communications for the computer monitor business.

Professional Development

Mentorship

- Selected for mentorship with Miles Kahler through the APSA Mentoring Program (2025) and IHS Mentoring Program (2026).

Research Training

- Inter-University Consortium for Political and Social Research (ICPSR), University of Michigan
  – ***Causal Inference: An SEM Approach*** (Sandy Marquart-Pyatt), 2025
  – ***Regression Analysis II: Linear Models*** (Timothy McDaniel), 2019
- ***Advanced Topics in Liberty: Liberty, War, and Peace Colloquia***, Institute for Humane Studies, 2024
- ***U.S. Foreign Policy Colloquium***, National Committee on U.S.–China Relations, 2019

Teaching Training

- **Faculty Career Fellow Program**, University at Albany, SUNY, 2026-2027
- **CIRTL Associate Fellow Certificate**, Center for the Integration of Research, Teaching, and Learning (CIRTL), Texas A&M University, 2024
- *POLS 681:* ***Teaching Seminar***, Texas A&M University, Spring 2024

Pre-Ph.D. Academic Programs and Field Studies

- Annual Symposium of Chinese Austrian School Economists, Taiyuan, China, 2017
- Field Research and Workshop, Bangkok, Thailand, 2015. Jointly organized by Kyoto University, Chulalongkorn University, and Thammasat University; presented "Environmental Performance and the Promotion of Local Officials in China".
- Herrenhausen Symposium, Hanover, Germany, 2015 -- paper accepted but unable to attend
- Northeast Asia Economic Forum **Young Leaders Program**, Seoul & Busan, South Korea, 2014. Selected as one of approximately 20–30 fellows from the United States, China, Russia, Japan, South Korea, and Mongolia; presented "China: The Way Ahead"
- Ninth IIDS–IIMS International Conference (ICSD 2014), University of Bonn, Germany, 2014. Presented "Management of Agricultural Sector: India, China and Russia"

- Field Study on Korean Industry and Economy, Seoul, South Korea, 2013 -- Kyoto University & Seoul National University

Service

Conference Service

- **Panel Organizer,** "Economic Statecraft and Rising Power Foreign Policy," APSA Annual Meeting, 2026.
- Discussant, Junior Scholars Symposium, Cato Institute, 2023.
- Discussant, International Studies Association (ISA) Annual Convention, 2023.

University and Department Service

Texas A&M University, Department of Political Science

- **Founding Editor-in-Chief**, *POLS Aggie Journal on the United States, China, and the World Order*, 2024–2025
- **Founding Organizer**, *Forum on the United States, China, and the World Order*, 2024–2025

Johns Hopkins University, School of Advanced International Studies (SAIS)

- Editor, *SAIS China Studies Review*, 2018–2019
- New Cohort Consultant, 2021

Professional Memberships

- American Political Science Association (APSA)
- Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA)
- International Studies Association (ISA)

Skills

Methods & Tools

- **Quantitative Analysis:** Linear and generalized linear models (OLS, MLE), panel data and fixed-effects models (TSCS), causal inference methods (DiD, stacked designs, IV), multilevel modeling, structural equation modeling (SEM), GIS and geospatial data processing (geospatial data linkage, distance-buffer identification, spatial joins), and survey experiments
- **Computational:** Advanced in R and Stata; intermediate in Python, LaTeX, web scraping, corpus construction, and computational text analysis
- **Data Collection Platforms**: Qualtrics, Amazon Mechanical Turk (MTurk), Prolific

Languages

- **English**: Fluent (Research, Teaching, Academic Writing)
- **Chinese (Mandarin & Cantonese)**: Bilingual
- **Japanese**: Basic

References

Matthew Fuhrmann
Dean Rusk Chair and Professor
Lyndon B. Johnson School of Public Affairs
The University of Texas at Austin
matthew.fuhrmann@austin.utexas.edu

Miles Kahler
Research Professor-in-Residence
Distinguished Professor Emeritus
School of International Service
American University
kahler@american.edu

Andrew Mertha
George and Sadie Hyman Professor of China Studies
School of Advanced International Studies
Johns Hopkins University
amertha1@jhu.edu

Hyeran Jo
Professor
Department of Political Science
Texas A&M University
hyeranjo@tamu.edu

Matt Malis
Assistant Professor
School of Politics, Economics & Global Affairs
IE University
mmalis@faculty.ie.edu